

5. Coding Exercise

The following sample texts with solutions for the identification of quasi-sentences and categories serve as exercises of coding.

GREAT BRITAIN, The Liberal/SDP Alliance 1983

'Working together for Britain'

(Extracts)

The General Election on June 9 th , 1983 will be seen as a watershed in British politics. //	000
It may be recalled as the fateful day when depression became hopelessness and the slide of the post-war years accelerated into the depths of decline. // Alternatively it may be remembered as the turning point when the people of this country, at the eleventh hour, decided to turn their backs on dogma and bitterness and chose a new road of partnership and progress. //	000
It is to offer real hope of a fresh start for Britain that the Alliance between our two parties has been created. // What we have done is unique in the history of British parliamentary democracy. // Two parties, one with a proud history, and one born only two years ago out of a frustration with the old systems of politics, have come together to offer an alternative government pledged to bring the country together again. //	305
The Conservative and Labour parties between them have made an industrial wasteland out of a country which was once the workshop of the world. // Manufacturing output from Britain is back to the level of nearly 20 years ago. // Unemployment is still rising and there are now generations of school-leavers who no longer even hope for work. // Mrs Thatcher's government stands idly by, hoping that the blind forces of the marketplace will restore the jobs and factories that its indifference has destroyed. // The Labour Party's response is massive further nationalisation, a centralised state socialist economy and rigid controls over enterprise. // The choice which Tories and socialists offer at this election is one between neglect and interference. // Neither of them understands that it is only by working together in the companies and communities of Britain that we can overcome the economic problems which beset us. // Meanwhile the very fabric of our common life together deteriorates. //	305
The record wave of violence and crime and increased personal stress are all signs of a society at war with itself. // Rundown cities and declining rural services alike tell a story of a warped sense of priorities by successive governments. // Mrs Thatcher promised 'to bring harmony where there is discord'. // Instead her own example of confrontation has inflamed the bitterness so many people feel at what has happened to their own lives and local communities. //	606

Our Alliance wants to call a halt to confrontation politics. // We believe we have set an example by working together as two separate parties within an alliance of principle. // Our whole approach is based on co-operation: not just between our parties but between management and workers, between people of different races and above all between government and people. // Because we are not prisoners of ideology we shall listen to the people we represent and ensure that the good sense of the voters is allowed to illuminate the corridors of Westminster and Whitehall. //

THE IMMEDIATE CRISIS: JOBS AND PRICES

Our economic crisis demands tough immediate action. // It also requires a Government with the courage to implement those strategic and structural reforms which alone can end the civil war between the two sides of industry. //

The immediate priority is to reduce unemployment. Why? // To the Alliance unemployment is a scandal; // robbing men and women of their careers; // blighting the prospects for a quarter of all our young people, // wasting our national resources, // aborting our chances of industrial recovery, // dividing our nation // and fuelling hopelessness and crime. //

Much of the present unemployment is a direct result of the civil war in British industry, of restrictive practices and low investment. // But in addition, conservative Government policies have caused unemployment to rise. // An Alliance Government would cause unemployment to fall. How? // Can it be done without releasing a fresh wave of inflation? //

We believe it can. // We propose a carefully devised and costed jobs programme aimed at reducing unemployment by 1 million over two years. // This programme will be supported by immediate measures to help those hardest hit by the slump - the disadvantaged, the pensioners, the poor. //

Ours is a programme of mind, heart and will. // It is a programme that will work! The Programme has three points: // Fiscal and Financial Policies for Growth; // Direct Action to provide jobs; // An Incomes Strategy that will stick. //

STRATEGY FOR INDUSTRIAL SUCCESS

The Alliance is alone in recognising that Britain's industrial crisis cannot be solved by short-term measures such as import controls or money supply targets. // Our crisis goes deep. // Its roots lie in the class divisions of our society, // in the vested interests of the Tory and Labour parties, // in the refusal of management and unions to wide democracy in industry, // in the way profits and risks are shared. //

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The policies offered by the two class-based parties will further divide the nation North v South, Management v Labour. // Our greatest need is to build a sense of belonging to one community. // We are all in it together. // It is impossible for one side or the other in Britain to 'win'. // Conflict in industrial relations means that we all lose. //

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The Alliance is committed to policies which will invest resources in the high-technology industries of the future. // We are committed to a major new effort in education and training. // We are pledged to trade union reform to tough anti-monopoly measures. //

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PARTNERSHIP IN INDUSTRY

Britain has made little progress towards industrial democracy, yet several of our European partners have long traditions of participation and co-operation backed by legislation. // They do not face the obstacles to progress with which our divisive industrial relations present us. // To be fully effective, proposals for participation in industry need to be buttressed by action on two fronts: // a major extension of profit sharing and worker share-ownership to give people a real stake where they work as well as the ability to participate in decision-taking, // and reform of the trade unions to make them genuinely representative institutions. //

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PARTICIPATION AT WORK

We propose enabling legislation that will offer a flexible and sensible approach: //

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An Industrial Democracy Act to provide for the introduction of employee participation at all levels, // incentives for employee share-ownership, // employee rights to information, // and an Industrial Democracy Agency (IDA) to advise on and monitor the introduction of these measures: //

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Employee Councils covering each place of work (subject to exemption for small units) for all companies employing over 1,000 people. // Smaller companies would also be encouraged to introduce Employee Councils. //

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GOVERNMENT AND INDUSTRY

Priority for Industry

The role of an Alliance government in relation to private industry will be to provide selective assistance taking a number of forms: // 402

an industrial credit scheme to provide low-interest, long-term finance for projects directed at modernising industry; // 402

A national innovation policy, to provide selective assistance for high-risk projects, // 402
 // particularly involving the development of new technologies // and for research and 411
 development in potential growth industries; // 410

Public purchasing policies to stimulate innovation, // encourage the introduction of 411
 crucial technologies // and aid small businesses; // 411
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we will establish a Cabinet Committee chaired by the Prime Minister at the centre of decision-taking on all policies with a bearing on the performance of industry. // 303

The Alliance will strengthen the Monopolies' and Mergers' Commission to ensure its ability to prevent monopoly and unhealthy concentrations of industrial and commercial power. // 403
 // The aim is to guarantee fair competition and to protect the interests of employers, 403
 consumers and shareholders. //

New and Small Business

To encourage the growth of new and small businesses, we will attack red tape and provide further financial and management assistance by: // 402

Extending the Loan Guarantee Scheme, in the first instance raising the maximum permitted loan to £150,000; // 402
 // and the Business Start-Up Scheme, raising the upper limit for 402
 investment to £75,000; // and introducing Small Firm Investment Companies to provide 402
 financial and management help; //

zero-rating building repairs and maintenance for VAT purposes // and reducing 402
 commercial rates by 10 per cent; // 402

making sure the Department of Industry co-ordinates and publicises schemes for small businesses // and that government aid ceases to discriminate against small businesses; // 402
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Tailoring national legislation such as the Health and Safety Regulations to the needs of small businesses // and amending the statutory sick pay scheme to exclude small businesses. 402
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Agriculture and Fisheries

Agriculture is an important industry and employer. // To encourage its further development we will: //

Increase Government support for effective agricultural marketing at home and abroad // and continue support for 'Food from Britain'; //

ensure that agriculture has access like other industries to the industrial credit scheme we propose; //

encourage greater access to farming, especially by young entrants. //

The Alliance is determined to safeguard the future of our fishing industry which needs help to re-build after years of uncertainty and the drastic consequences for the deep-sea fleet of 200-mile limits in the waters they used to fish. //

Education and training

The third basic condition for industrial success is a people with the skills and self-confidence that will be needed for the challenges of new technology. // The education and training systems are not providing enough people with the skills necessary to make them employable and the country successful in competition with its rivals. // We are falling further behind. // Japan on present plans will be educating all its young people to the age of 18 by 1990. // More than 90 per cent of the 16-19 age group in Germany gain recognised technical qualifications. // And it is not just a matter of school-leavers. // Our managers are less professionally qualified than our main competitors. // From the bottom to top we are underskilled, and this has to be put right if we are to prosper in future. // To do this, to raise standards in education and training and to improve their effectiveness is the object of proposals set out in the next Section. //

NEW ZEALAND, National Party 1972

"A Guide to what the next National Government will do for New Zealand"

(Extracts)

THE ECONOMY

In 1972 New Zealand had, for the first time, more overseas reserves than total overseas debt. // Labour has dissipated these reserves, borrowed about \$2,00 million overseas and incurred annual interest charges mortgaging almost our total export earnings from butter and cheese. //

Inflation in 1972 was about 5 per cent, the second lowest of the Organisation for

Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) nations. // Today it is about 15 per cent, well above the OECD average, // and New Zealand has an external deficit per head of population second only to Iceland. // 414 414

The first three years of the coming National Government will be very largely devoted to restoring New Zealand's shattered economy. // 408

Continuous attention to economic trends and problems will replace stop-go and panic measures. // And the taxation system will be used to give incentives for desirable economic activity. // 408 402

We will take steps to stimulate savings. // Savings accounts, limited as to amount, will be established. // The deposits of individuals will earn an interest rate at least equal to the annual rate of inflation thus preserving the purchasing power of savings. // 414 414 414

We believe that continued double-figure inflation will destroy the basis of the New Zealand economy and cause untold misery. // The fight against increases in the cost of living is the most important single issue in economic management. // 414 414

People without jobs represent waste of productive effort: // National supports a policy of full employment // and the dignity of labour. // We do not accept unemployment as a balancing factor in economic management. // 410 408 701 701

Finally, the National Development Council will be restored and consultation resumed between Government departments, academic specialists and private industry, including farming and organised labour. // The vital role of every section of productive industry will be recognised. // 405 405

It is these moves which will put New Zealand on the way to economic recovery. // And reduce the spiraling rate of inflation. // 408 414

SUPERANNUATION

Seldom has any policy released by an opposition party had the impact that the National Superannuation scheme has had. // It is designed to give every New Zealander dignity and a decent income in retirement. // Here's how it will operate: // 504 504 504

Anyone who is 60 years old, or more, and who has lived in New Zealand for at least ten years will receive National Superannuation, starting next year. // And with three big annual jumps in the rate of benefit it will be fully operating by 1978. // 504 504

To guarantee our elderly retired folk a decent minimum income, the full rate of National Superannuation, for a married couple, will be 80% of the average weekly ordinary time 504 504

wage. // It will be recalculated every six months. //

In 1976, to start the scheme, the rate will be 65% of the average wage; // in 1977 it will be raised to 70% // and in 1978 to the full 80%.// The rate for single persons, at all times, will be 60% of the married rate. //

The present average weekly wage is \$99 and so, if there is no increase at all in wage rates in the next three years, the rates of National Superannuation will be shown in the box* below (*box not shown). //

Next year, under National, the age and universal superannuation benefits will merge to form National Superannuation. //

At present both these benefits pay \$51.26 to a married couple and \$30.75 to a single person, so even in the first year of National Superannuation, a married couple over 60 who have no other income will have \$6.18 a week more to spend than they do now and a single beneficiary will receive, after tax, \$3.15 a week more than he now gets by way of age benefits, or universal superannuation. //

Of course those with other income will receive the benefit too, but they will pay more tax on their bigger incomes. //

By 1978 a married couple will receive a net \$18.06 a week more than the present age benefit or universal annuation and a single person will be receiving a net \$10.17 a week more. // For the single person, that is a pay rise of more than 33%.//

The big and comforting thing about National Superannuation is that everyone gets it, just so long as they have lived in New Zealand for ten years or more and are aged 60 or over. //

They will not, nor will anyone, be expected to make special contributions over a period of years, in order to qualify. // The scheme is financed out of ordinary taxation so there is nothing to be deducted from wages; no special payments of any kind. //

This means that the present age beneficiary will receive National Superannuation next year. // So will the retired Government servant (in addition to the pension from the Government superannuation fund which he had paid for). // And so will all the people who are drawing pensions from company and other private superannuation schemes. //

In recent weeks, the Government has been making moves to compensate for the weaknesses revealed in their own scheme, when compared with National's. // But the fact remains that National's is the only superannuation scheme that offers a fair deal to everyone in their years of retirement. //

WOMEN'S RIGHTS

Since 1975 is International Women's Year, it can be expected that all political parties will talk a great deal about their 'women's policies'. // Unfortunately most will be little more than window dressing. // National's plans go far beyond this. //	706 706 706
We will begin by introducing legislation to remove existing legal discrimination relating to women, // and to prohibit discrimination against any person by reason of sex. //	503 503
We will also establish a Human Rights Commission which will ensure that equal rights legislation is enforced and that women have an effective and inexpensive means of redress. // The Commission will investigate cases of discrimination presented to it and recommend civil action to the Attorney-General. //	503 503
Full consideration will be given to the recommendations of the Select Committee on Women's Rights. // We will set priorities for implementation, in consultation with women's organisations. //	706 706
We will legislate to ensure that all areas of discrimination in employment are removed // and that merit is the sole criterion in respect of job applications, selection and promotion. //	503 503
To encourage women who wish to enter, return to or remain in employment, National will encourage employers to establish flexible working patterns, such as glide time, part-time, job sharing, and multi-shift work. // Thus assisting women who undertake the dual role of worker and mother. //	706 706
We will give special attention to the problems associated with re-entry to the work force and ensure that greater job retraining opportunities are available. //	706
Maternity leave without pay will be available to women for a period of up to 12 weeks, without loss of job security, promotion or superannuation rights, providing this does not cause undue disruption to a business enterprise. //	706
The new National Government will appoint women to boards, commissions and tribunals and will give consideration to the appointment of women as industrial mediators. //	706
We will also support increased participation of women in the judicial system and recognise no sex barriers in the exercise of any judicial office. // Suitably qualified women will be given exactly the same consideration as men. //	503 503
National will ensure that early childhood education is generally available (where feasible) as an integral part of the education system. // Priority will be given to such areas as new housing suburbs and regenerated inner city areas. //	506 411
Financial assistance will be provided through approved voluntary agencies to establish	504

centres for those children who need day care but whose parents cannot afford to pay the full cost. //

National will also promote and encourage job training and retraining, "second chance" education // and promote a policy of life-long education for women. //

We will tackle the problems women face with housing. // Under National the Housing Corporation will not differentiate between men and women borrowers on grounds of sex. //

We will introduce a flexible principal repayment plan to meet those cases where the wife works, leaves the work force to raise a family and then returns to work. //

The National Party believes all women must have the opportunity to participate on the basis of full equality in the social, cultural, economic and political spheres of New Zealand society. //